

(2006年Text 1)

一、文章主旨

英文主旨： This text argues that American society is a powerful homogenizing machine that successfully assimilates immigrants into its common culture, as evidenced by immigrants' mastery of English, high home ownership rates, and intermarriage, and concludes that today's American social environment is not dark or deteriorating despite some divisive issues.

中文主旨： 本文指出美国社会是一台强大的同化机器，能成功将移民融入其大众文化中，通过移民对英语的掌握、高住房拥有率以及异族通婚等数据证明了这一点，并得出结论：尽管存在一些分裂性问题，当今美国的社会环境并未呈现黑暗、恶化的态势。

二、逐句精读（翻译+考点词汇+长难句分析）

1. **原文：** In spite of "endless talk of difference," American society is an amazing machine for homogenizing people.

翻译： 尽管人们“无休止地谈论差异”，美国社会仍是一台令人惊叹的同化人的机器。

常考单词/短语：

- in spite of: 尽管，不管（考研高频短语）
- endless /'endləs/ adj. 无休止的，无止境的
- homogenize /hə'mɒdʒənaɪz/ v. 使同化，使均匀（考研核心词，同源名词 homogenization）
- amazing /ə'meɪzɪŋ/ adj. 令人惊叹的，惊人的

2. **原文：** There is "the democratizing uniformity of dress and discourse, and the casualness and absence of deference" characteristic of popular culture.

翻译： 大众文化具有“民主化的着装与话语统一，以及随意、不拘礼节”的特征。

常考单词/短语：

- democratize /dɪ'mɒkrətaɪz/ v. 使民主化（形容词 democratizing，民主化的）
- uniformity /ju:nɪ'fɔ:məti/ n. 统一性，一致性（形容词 uniform）
- discourse /'dɪskɔ:s/ n. 话语，谈话；论述（考研高频词）
- casualness /'kæʒuəlness/ n. 随意，漫不经心（形容词 casual）
- absence /'æbsəns/ n. 缺乏，不存在（形容词 absent）
- deference /'defərəns/ n. 顺从，尊重（短语 in deference to 遵从）
- characteristic of: 是...的特征（考研高频短语）
- popular culture: 大众文化，流行文化

3. **原文：** People are absorbed into "a culture of consumption" launched by the 19th-century department stores that offered "vast arrays of goods in an elegant atmosphere."

翻译： 人们被19世纪百货商店所开创的“消费文化”所吸引，这些百货商店“在优雅的环境中提供琳琅满目的商品”。

常考单词/短语：

- be absorbed into: 被...吸引，融入...（考研高频短语，absorb /əb'sɔ:b/ v. 吸收；使全神贯注）
- consumption /kən'sʌmpʃn/ n. 消费，消耗（动词 consume）
- launch /lɔ:ntʃ/ v. 发起，开创；发射
- department store: 百货商店
- vast arrays of: 大量的，琳琅满目的（array /ə'reɪ/ n. 一系列，大量）

- elegant /'elɪɡənt/ adj. 优雅的, 雅致的
- atmosphere /'ætməsfɪə(r)/ n. 环境, 氛围; 大气

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: People are absorbed into "a culture of consumption"
- 修饰成分:
 - launched by the 19th-century department stores: 过去分词短语作后置定语, 修饰a culture of consumption
 - that offered "vast arrays of goods in an elegant atmosphere": 定语从句, 修饰先行词department stores
- 翻译逻辑: 拆分翻译, 先译主干, 再译定语部分, 符合中文表达习惯

4. **原文:** Instead of intimate shops catering to a knowledgeable elite" these were stores "anyone could enter, regardless of class or background.

翻译: 这些商店并非迎合知识精英的私密小店, 而是“无论阶层或背景, 任何人都可以进入”的场所。

常考单词/短语:

- instead of: 而不是, 代替 (考研高频短语)
- intimate /'ɪntɪmət/ adj. 私密的, 亲密的
- cater to: 迎合, 满足 (...的需求) (考研高频短语)
- knowledgeable /'nɒlɪdʒəbl/ adj. 知识渊博的, 有见识的
- elite /eɪ'li:t/ n. 精英, 上层人士
- regardless of: 不管, 不顾 (考研高频短语)
- background /'bækgraʊnd/ n. 背景, 出身

5. **原文:** This turned shopping into a public and democratic act."

翻译: 这将购物转变为一种公共、民主的行为。

常考单词/短语:

- turn...into...: 把...转变成... (考研高频短语)
- democratic /,demə'krætɪk/ adj. 民主的 (名词democracy)
- act /ækt/ n. 行为, 行动

6. **原文:** The mass media, advertising and sports are other forces for homogenization.

翻译: 大众媒体、广告和体育是促成同化的其他力量。

常考单词/短语:

- mass media: 大众媒体 (考研高频短语)
- advertising /'ædvətaɪzɪŋ/ n. 广告 (动词advertise)
- force /fɔ:s/ n. 力量, 影响力; v. 强迫
- homogenization /hə'mɒdʒənəɪ'zeɪʃn/ n. 同化, 同质化 (动词homogenize)

7. **原文:** Immigrants are quickly fitting into this common culture, which may not be altogether elevating but is hardly poisonous.

翻译: 移民正快速融入这种大众文化, 这种文化或许并非完全高尚, 但绝无危害。

常考单词/短语:

- fit into: 融入, 适应 (考研高频短语)
- common culture: 大众文化, 共同文化
- altogether /ˌɔ:ltə'geðə(r)/ adv. 完全, 总共
- elevating /'elɪveɪtɪŋ/ adj. 高尚的, 有提升作用的 (动词elevate 提升)
- hardly /'hɑ:dli/ adv. 几乎不, 绝不 (考研高频词)
- poisonous /'pɔɪzənəs/ adj. 有毒的, 有害的 (名词poison)

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: Immigrants are quickly fitting into this common culture
- 修饰成分: which may not be altogether elevating but is hardly poisonous: 非限制性定语从句, 修饰先行词this common culture, 补充说明该文化的特点

- 翻译逻辑：顺译，将定语从句译为独立分句，符合中文表达

8. **原文**：Writing for the National Immigration Forum, Gregory Rodriguez reports that today's immigration is neither at unprecedented levels nor resistant to assimilation.

翻译：格雷戈里·罗德里格斯为国家移民论坛撰文时指出，如今的移民既未达到前所未有的规模，也不抗拒同化。

常考单词/短语：

- write for：为...撰稿，为...写作
- forum /'fɔ:rəm/ n. 论坛，讨论会
- report /rɪ'pɔ:t/ v. 报道，指出，报告
- immigration /,ɪmɪ'greɪʃn/ n. 移民（动词immigrate）
- neither...nor...：既不...也不...（考研高频结构）
- unprecedented /ʌn'presɪdntɪd/ adj. 前所未有的，空前的（考研核心词）
- be resistant to：抗拒，抵抗（考研高频短语，resistant /rɪ'zɪstənt/ adj. 抵抗的）
- assimilation /ə,sɪmə'leɪʃn/ n. 同化（动词assimilate）

长难句结构分析：

- 主干：Gregory Rodriguez reports that...（宾语从句）
- 修饰成分：Writing for the National Immigration Forum：现在分词短语作伴随状语，说明主语的动作背景
- 宾语从句主干：today's immigration is neither at unprecedented levels nor resistant to assimilation
- 翻译逻辑：顺译，先译状语，再译主干，符合中文语序

9. **原文**：In 1998 immigrants were 9.8 percent of the population; in 1900, 13.6 percent.

翻译：1998年，移民占总人口的9.8%；1900年，这一比例为13.6%。

常考单词/短语：

- percent /pə'sent/ n. 百分比，百分率
- population /,pɒpjʊ'leɪʃn/ n. 人口

10. **原文**：In the 10 years prior to 1990, 3.1 immigrants arrived for every 1,000 residents; in the 10 years prior to 1890, 9.2 for every 1,000.

翻译：1990年之前的10年间，每1000名居民中有3.1名移民迁入；1890年之前的10年间，每1000名居民中有9.2名移民迁入。

常考单词/短语：

- prior to：在...之前，先于（考研高频短语，prior /'praɪə(r)/ adj. 先前的）
- resident /'rezɪdnt/ n. 居民，住户（名词residence）
- arrive /ə'raɪv/ v. 到达，迁入

11. **原文**：Now, consider three indices of assimilation — language, home ownership and intermarriage.

翻译：现在，我们来考察同化的三个指标——语言、住房拥有率和异族通婚。

常考单词/短语：

- consider /kən'sɪdə(r)/ v. 考察，思考，认为
- index /'ɪndeks/ n. 指标，指数（复数indices）
- assimilation /ə,sɪmə'leɪʃn/ n. 同化
- home ownership：住房拥有率（ownership /'əʊnəʃɪp/ n. 所有权）
- intermarriage /,ɪntə'mæərɪdʒ/ n. 异族通婚，近亲结婚（inter- 表示“相互、之间”）

12. **原文**：The 1990 Census revealed that "a majority of immigrants from each of the fifteen most common countries of origin spoke English 'well' or 'very well' after ten years of residence."

翻译：1990年的人口普查显示，“来自15个最常见移民来源国的大多数移民，在居住10年后，英语说得‘好’或‘非常好’”。

常考单词/短语：

- census /'sensəs/ n. 人口普查，统计调查（考研核心词）

- reveal /rɪˈvi:l/ v. 显示, 揭示, 透露 (考研高频词)
- a majority of: 大多数的 (考研高频短语, majority /məˈdʒɔrəti/ n. 大多数)
- origin /ˈɒrɪdʒɪn/ n. 起源, 来源 (形容词original)
- residence /ˈrezɪdəns/ n. 居住, 住所 (动词reside)

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: The 1990 Census revealed that... (宾语从句)
- 宾语从句主干: a majority of immigrants spoke English 'well' or 'very well'
- 修饰成分:
 - from each of the fifteen most common countries of origin: 介词短语作后置定语, 修饰immigrants
 - after ten years of residence: 介词短语作时间状语
- 翻译逻辑: 顺译, 先译主干, 再译定语和状语, 符合中文语序

13. **原文:** The children of immigrants tend to be bilingual and proficient in English.

翻译: 移民的子女往往会说两种语言, 并且精通英语。

常考单词/短语:

- tend to: 往往, 倾向于 (考研高频短语)
- bilingual /ˌbaɪˈlɪŋɡwəl/ adj. 双语的, 会说两种语言的 (bi- 表示“两个”, lingual 语言的)
- proficient /prəˈfɪʃnt/ adj. 精通的, 熟练的 (短语be proficient in 精通..., 名词proficiency)

14. **原文:** "By the third generation, the original language is lost in the majority of immigrant families."

翻译: “到了第三代, 大多数移民家庭的母语都消失了。”

常考单词/短语:

- by the third generation: 到第三代 (by 表示“到...时候”)
- original /əˈrɪdʒənəl/ adj. 原来的, 最初的 (名词origin)
- be lost: 消失, 丢失
- a majority of: 大多数的

15. **原文:** Hence the description of America as a "graveyard" for languages.

翻译: 因此, 美国被描述为语言的“坟墓”。

常考单词/短语:

- hence /hens/ adv. 因此, 从此 (考研高频词, 表因果)
- description /dɪˈskrɪpʃn/ n. 描述, 形容 (动词describe)
- graveyard /ˈɡreɪvja:d/ n. 坟墓, 墓地

16. **原文:** By 1996 foreign-born immigrants who had arrived before 1970 had a home ownership rate of 75.6 percent, higher than the 69.8 percent rate among native-born Americans.

翻译: 到1996年, 1970年之前迁入的外国出生移民的住房拥有率为75.6%, 高于美国本土出生者69.8%的住房拥有率。

常考单词/短语:

- foreign-born: 外国出生的 (复合形容词)
- native-born: 本土出生的 (复合形容词)
- home ownership rate: 住房拥有率
- higher than: 高于 (比较级结构)

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: foreign-born immigrants had a home ownership rate of 75.6 percent
- 修饰成分:
 - who had arrived before 1970: 定语从句, 修饰先行词foreign-born immigrants

- higher than the 69.8 percent rate among native-born Americans: 形容词短语作比较状语, 补充说明75.6%的情况

○ 翻译逻辑: 顺译, 先译定语从句, 再译主干, 最后译比较部分, 符合中文表达

17. **原文:** Foreign-born Asians and Hispanics "have higher rates of intermarriage than do U.S.-born whites and blacks."

翻译: 外国出生的亚裔和西班牙裔“异族通婚率高于美国本土出生的白人和黑人”。

常考单词/短语:

- Hispanic /hɪˈspæniːk/ n. 西班牙裔美国人 (adj. 西班牙裔的)
- intermarriage /ˌɪntəˈmæriɪdʒ/ n. 异族通婚
- higher than: 高于 (比较级结构, 此处than后用倒装do U.S.-born whites and blacks, 正常语序为U.S.-born whites and blacks do, do指代have rates of intermarriage)

18. **原文:** By the third generation, one third of Hispanic women are married to non-Hispanics, and 41 percent of Asian-American women are married to non-Asians.

翻译: 到了第三代, 三分之一的西班牙裔女性嫁给了非西班牙裔, 41%的亚裔美国女性嫁给了非亚裔。

常考单词/短语:

- one third: 三分之一 (分数表达, 基数词+序数词, 分子大于1时分词加s)
- be married to: 与...结婚 (考研高频短语)
- Asian-American: 亚裔美国人 (复合名词)

19. **原文:** Rodriguez notes that children in remote villages around the world are fans of superstars like Arnold Schwarzenegger and Garth Brooks, yet "some Americans fear that immigrants living within the United States remain somehow immune to the nation's assimilative power."

翻译: 罗德里格斯指出, 世界各地偏远村庄的孩子都是阿诺德·施瓦辛格、加斯·布鲁克斯等超级明星的粉丝, 然而“一些美国人担心, 居住在美国的移民在某种程度上对这个国家的同化力免疫”。

常考单词/短语:

- note /nəʊt/ v. 指出, 注意到 (考研高频词)
- remote /rɪˈməʊt/ adj. 偏远的, 遥远的
- around the world: 世界各地 (考研高频短语)
- superstar /ˈsuːpəstɑː(r)/ n. 超级明星
- fear /fiə(r)/ v. 担心, 害怕
- immune /ɪˈmjuːn/ adj. 免疫的, 不受影响的 (短语be immune to 对...免疫, 不受...影响, 考研高频短语)
- assimilative /əˈsɪmɪlətɪv/ adj. 同化的 (动词assimilate)
- somehow /ˈsʌmhaʊ/ adv. 以某种方式, 在某种程度上

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: Rodriguez notes that... (宾语从句1)
- 宾语从句1主干: children are fans of superstars, yet "some Americans fear that... (宾语从句2) "
- 修饰成分:
 - in remote villages around the world: 介词短语作后置定语, 修饰children
 - like Arnold Schwarzenegger and Garth Brooks: 介词短语作举例, 修饰superstars
 - living within the United States: 现在分词短语作后置定语, 修饰immigrants
 - that immigrants...remain somehow immune to the nation's assimilative power: 宾语从句2, 作fear的宾语
- 翻译逻辑: 顺译, 拆分两个宾语从句, 先译前半部分, 再译转折后的部分, 符合中文语序

20. **原文**: Are there divisive issues and pockets of seething anger in America? Indeed.

翻译: 美国是否存在分裂性问题和范围强烈的不满? 确实存在。

常考单词/短语:

- divisive /di'vaɪsɪv/ adj. 分裂的, 造成不和的 (动词divide)
- issue /'ɪʃu:/ n. 问题, 议题 (考研高频词)
- pockets of: 小范围的, 一小块 (考研高频短语, pocket 此处表示“小区域”)
- seething /'si:ðɪŋ/ adj. 强烈的, 沸腾的 (seethe /si:ð/ v. 沸腾, 发怒)
- anger /'æŋɡə(r)/ n. 愤怒, 不满

21. **原文**: It is big enough to have a bit of everything.

翻译: 美国足够大, 包容万象。

常考单词/短语:

- enough to: 足够...去做 (考研高频结构)
- a bit of everything: 各种各样的事物, 万象

22. **原文**: But particularly when viewed against America's turbulent past, today's social indices hardly suggest a dark and deteriorating social environment.

翻译: 但尤其是与美国动荡的过去相比, 如今的社会指标几乎不表明社会环境处于黑暗、恶化的状态。

常考单词/短语:

- particularly /pə'tɪkjələrlɪ/ adv. 尤其, 特别 (形容词particular)
- view against: 与...相比, 对照...来看 (考研高频短语)
- turbulent /'tɜ:bjələnt/ adj. 动荡的, 混乱的 (考研核心词)
- social indices: 社会指标 (index的复数indices)
- hardly /'hɑ:dli/ adv. 几乎不, 绝不
- deteriorating /dɪ'tɪəriəreɪtɪŋ/ adj. 恶化的, 越来越糟的 (动词deteriorate)
- environment /ɪn'veɪrənmənt/ n. 环境

长难句结构分析:

- 主干: today's social indices hardly suggest a dark and deteriorating social environment
- 修饰成分:
 - when viewed against America's turbulent past: 省略主语和be动词的时间状语从句, 完整形式为when (they are) viewed against America's turbulent past, they指代today's social indices
 - particularly: 副词作状语, 修饰整个从句
- 翻译逻辑: 顺译, 先译状语从句, 再译主干, 符合中文语序

三、文章原文

In spite of "endless talk of difference," American society is an amazing machine for homogenizing people. There is "the democratizing uniformity of dress and discourse, and the casualness and absence of deference" characteristic of popular culture. People are absorbed into "a culture of consumption" launched by the 19th-century department stores that offered "vast arrays of goods in an elegant atmosphere." Instead of intimate shops catering to a knowledgeable elite" these were stores "anyone could enter, regardless of class or background. This turned shopping into a public and democratic act." The mass media, advertising and sports are other forces for homogenization.

Immigrants are quickly fitting into this common culture, which may not be altogether elevating but is hardly poisonous. Writing for the National Immigration Forum, Gregory Rodriguez reports that today's immigration is neither at unprecedented levels nor resistant to assimilation. In 1998 immigrants were 9.8 percent of the population; in 1900, 13.6 percent. In the 10 years prior to 1990, 3.1 immigrants arrived for every 1,000 residents; in the 10 years prior to 1890, 9.2 for every 1,000. Now, consider three indices of assimilation — language, home ownership and intermarriage.

The 1990 Census revealed that "a majority of immigrants from each of the fifteen most common countries of origin spoke English 'well' or 'very well' after ten years of residence." The children of immigrants tend to be bilingual and proficient in English. "By the third generation, the original language is lost in the majority of immigrant families." Hence the description of America as a "graveyard" for languages. By 1996 foreign-born immigrants who had arrived before 1970 had a home ownership rate of 75.6 percent, higher than the 69.8 percent rate among native-born Americans.

Foreign-born Asians and Hispanics "have higher rates of intermarriage than do U.S.-born whites and blacks." By the third generation, one third of Hispanic women are married to non-Hispanics, and 41 percent of Asian-American women are married to non-Asians.

Rodriguez notes that children in remote villages around the world are fans of superstars like Arnold Schwarzenegger and Garth Brooks, yet "some Americans fear that immigrants living within the United States remain somehow immune to the nation's assimilative power."

Are there divisive issues and pockets of seething anger in America? Indeed. It is big enough to have a bit of everything. But particularly when viewed against America's turbulent past, today's social indices hardly suggest a dark and deteriorating social environment.

四、文章完整翻译

尽管人们“无休止地谈论差异”，美国社会仍是一台令人惊叹的同化人的机器。大众文化具有“民主化的着装与话语统一，以及随意、不拘礼节”的特征。人们被19世纪百货商店所开创的“消费文化”所吸引，这些百货商店“在优雅的环境中提供琳琅满目的商品”。这些商店并非迎合知识精英的秘密小店，而是“无论阶层或背景，任何人都可以进入”的场所。这将购物转变为一种公共、民主的行为。大众媒体、广告和体育是促成同化的其他力量。

移民正快速融入这种大众文化，这种文化或许并非完全高尚，但绝无危害。格雷戈里·罗德里格斯为国家移民论坛撰文时指出，如今的移民既未达到前所未有的规模，也不抗拒同化。1998年，移民占总人口的9.8%；1900年，这一比例为13.6%。1990年之前的10年间，每1000名居民中有3.1名移民迁入；1890年之前的10年间，每1000名居民中有9.2名移民迁入。现在，我们来考察同化的三个指标——语言、住房拥有率和异族通婚。

1990年的人口普查显示，“来自15个最常见移民来源国的大多数移民，在居住10年后，英语说得‘好’或‘非常好’”。移民的子女往往会说两种语言，并且精通英语。“到了第三代，大多数移民家庭的母语都消失了。”因此，美国被描述为语言的“坟墓”。到1996年，1970年之前迁入的外国出生移民的住房拥有率为75.6%，高于美国本土出生者69.8%的住房拥有率。

外国出生的亚裔和西班牙裔“异族通婚率高于美国本土出生的白人和黑人”。到了第三代，三分之一的西班牙裔女性嫁给了非西班牙裔，41%的亚裔美国女性嫁给了非亚裔。

罗德里格斯指出，世界各地偏远村庄的孩子都是阿诺德·施瓦辛格、加斯·布鲁克斯等超级明星的粉丝，然而“一些美国人担心，居住在美国的移民在某种程度上对这个国家的同化力免疫”。

美国是否存在分裂性问题和小范围的强烈不满？确实存在。美国足够大，包容万象。但尤其是与美国动荡的过去相比，如今的社会指标几乎不表明社会环境处于黑暗、恶化的状态。

